

Supplements We say a group G is **simple** if $G \neq \{1\}$ and $\forall N \triangleleft G, N = \{1\}, G$.

Example Cyclic group $\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$, all its subgroups are normal, and are $m\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}, m \mid n$.
Hence $\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$ is simple $\iff n$ is a prime.

In short, simple cyclic group $\approx \mathbb{Z}/p\mathbb{Z}, p$ prime $\approx G, |G| = p$.

Proposition Let H, K be subgroups of G , and $K \triangleleft G$. $HK := \{hk \mid h \in H, k \in K\} \subset G$ is a subgroup and $HK = KH$.

Proof First, $HK = KH : \forall h \in H, k \in K, hk = \underbrace{hkh^{-1}}_{\subset hKh^{-1}=K} h \in KH$, the other side is similar.

Next, HK is a subgroup:

- $1 = 1 \cdot 1 \in HK$,
- $h_1 k_1 \cdot h_2 k_2 \in h_1 K H k_2 = h_1 H K k_2 = HK$,
- $(hk)^{-1} = k^{-1} h^{-1} \in KH = HK$.

□

Generalization $\forall K \leq G$, define $Z_G(K) := \{g \in G \mid gkg^{-1} = k\}$ / 中心化子群 and $N_G(K) := \{g \in G \mid gKg^{-1} = K\}$ / 正规化子群.

From definition $Z_G(K) \leq N_G(K), K \triangleleft N_G(K)$.

Then, if $H, K \leq G$ s.t. $H \leq N_G(K)$, then $HK = KH$ is a subgroup.

Proof Work in $N_G(K)$ where $K \triangleleft N_G(K)$.

□

Proposition $H, K \leq G, H \leq N_G(K)$, then $H \cap K \triangleleft H$ and

$$\begin{aligned} HK/K &\simeq H/(H \cap K) \\ hK &\leftrightarrow h(H \cap K) \end{aligned}$$

Proof Let $x \in H \cap K, h \in H$. then $h x h^{-1} \in H, H \subset N_G(K) \implies h x h^{-1} \in K \implies H \cap K \triangleleft H$.

Consider $H \hookrightarrow HK \twoheadrightarrow HK/K$, its composite $=: f. f(h) = hK$.

- f is surjective: $hK = f(h)$.

$\ker(f) = H \cap K$ since $f(h) = K \iff hK = K \iff h \in K$.

Hence f induces $\bar{f} : H/(H \cap K) \simeq HK/K, \bar{f}(h(H \cap K)) = f(h) = hK$.

□

§ Semidirect products

Already seen: G_1, G_2 groups $\implies G_1 \times G_2$ is also a group.

Below is a “twisted” version.

External version Given H, N groups, homomorphism $\varphi : H \rightarrow \text{Aut}(N)$. On the set $N \times H$, define the binary operation $(n, h)(n', h') := (n\varphi_h(n'), hh')$, where $\varphi_h \in \text{Aut}(N)$ is the image of h .

To check: This makes $N \times H$ into a group $N \rtimes_{\varphi} H$ with $1_{N \rtimes_{\varphi} H} = (1_N, 1_H)$,
 $(n, h)^{-1} = (\varphi_{h^{-1}}(n^{-1}), h^{-1})$.

$N \hookrightarrow N \rtimes_{\varphi} H \hookrightarrow H$ as subgroups, and $n \mapsto (n, 1_H), h \mapsto (1_N, h), (n, 1_H)(1_N, h) = (n, h)$.
Also $N \triangleleft N \rtimes_{\varphi} H$.

Proof Idea: seek a group G s.t. $N \hookrightarrow G \hookrightarrow H, N \triangleleft G$, and every $g \in G$ can be expressed uniquely as $g = nh$. If so: $nh \cdot n'h' = \underbrace{nhn'h^{-1}}_{\in N} \cdot \underbrace{hh'}_{\in H}$, hence everything is covered by

$$\begin{aligned}\varphi : H &\rightarrow \text{Aut}(N) \\ h &\mapsto \varphi_h\end{aligned}$$

where $\varphi_h(n) = hnh^{-1}$ in G . Also $(nh)^{-1} = h^{-1}n^{-1} = (h^{-1}n^{-1}h)h^{-1} = \varphi_{h^{-1}}(n^{-1})h$.

Construction Build “ G ” on the set $N \times H$.

Associativity:

$$\begin{aligned}((n, h)(n', h'))(n'', h'') &= (n\varphi_h(n'), hh')(n'', h'') \\ &= (n\varphi_h(n')\varphi_{hh'}(n''), hh'h''), \\ (n, h)((n', h')(n'', h'')) &= (n, h)(n'\varphi_{h'}(n''), h'h'') \\ &= (n\varphi_h(n'\varphi_{h'}(n'')), hh'h'').\end{aligned}$$

To show: $\varphi_h(n')\varphi_{hh'}(n'') = [\varphi_h(n'\varphi_{h'}(n'')) = \varphi_h(n')\varphi_h(\varphi_{h'}(n''))]$,
 $\Leftarrow \varphi_{hh'}(n'') = \varphi_h(\varphi_{h'}(n''))$. φ is a homomorphism $\Rightarrow \varphi_{hh'} = \varphi_h \circ \varphi_{h'}$. ✓

Unit:

$$\begin{aligned}(1_N, 1_H)(n, h) &= (\varphi_1(n), h) = (n, h), \because \varphi_1 = 1_{\text{Aut}(N)} = \text{id}, \\ (n, h)(1_N, 1_H) &= (n\varphi_h(1_N), h) = (n, h), \because \varphi_h(1_N) = 1_N.\end{aligned}$$

Inverse: omitted.

Remains to show both embeds are homomorphisms (omitted), and

$$(n, 1_H)(1_N, h) = (n\varphi_1(1_N), h) = (n, h).$$

To show $N \triangleleft N \rtimes_\varphi H$, it suffices to show that

$$\begin{aligned}(1_N, h)(n, 1_N)(1_N, h)^{-1} &= (1_N, h)(n, 1_H)(1_N, h^{-1}) \\ &= (1_N, h)(n, h^{-1}) = (\varphi_h(n), 1_H) \in N.\end{aligned}$$

□

Special case: Take $\varphi_h = \text{id}_N, \forall h \in H \Rightarrow$ get $N \times H$.

Internal version Given a group G and subgroups $N, H \leq G$. When can we identify G with $N \rtimes_\varphi H$ for suitable φ s.t. $N \rtimes_\varphi H \simeq G$?

Proposition Assume $N \triangleleft G, G = NH, N \cap H = \{1\}$. Consider $\text{Ad} : H \rightarrow \text{Aut}(N)$, $\text{Ad}_h(n) = hnh^{-1}$. Then $\Phi : N \rtimes_{\text{Ad}} H \simeq G, (n, h) \mapsto nh$ with notation $G = N \rtimes H$.

Proof Φ is a homomorphism:

$$\begin{aligned}\Phi((n, h)(n', h')) &= \Phi(n\text{Ad}_h(n'), hh') \\ &= n\text{Ad}_h(n')hh' = nhn'h' = \Phi((n, h))\Phi((n', h')).\end{aligned}$$

Φ is surjective as $G = NH$.

$\Phi((n, h)) = 1 \Leftrightarrow nh = 1 \Leftrightarrow n = h^{-1} \in N \cap H = \{1\}$. Hence Φ is bijective.

□

Examples

- Let $n > 1$, $\tau := (i \ j) \in S_n$. Then:
 - $S_n = A_n \rtimes \langle \tau \rangle$,
 $\because A_n \cap \langle \tau \rangle = \{\text{id}\}$, $A_n = \ker(\text{sgn}) \triangleleft S_n$.
 $\forall \sigma \in S_n$, if $\sigma \notin A_n$ then $\text{sgn}(\sigma) = -1 \implies \sigma\tau \in A_n, \sigma \in A_n\tau$. Thus $S_n = A_n\langle \tau \rangle$.
 - Note that $n > 2 \implies S_n \not\cong A_n \times \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$, $\because Z(S_n) = \{\text{id}\}$, $Z(A_n \times \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}) \supset \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$.
- Dihedral groups / 二面体群

$$\text{SO}(2) \triangleleft \text{O}(2) := \{\text{orthogonal trans. in } \mathbb{R}^2\}$$

Let $n \geq 3$, $D_{2n} := \{T \in \text{O}(2) \mid T(\text{regular } n\text{-gon}) = \text{regular } n\text{-gon}\}$
 $\implies D_{2n}$ is a subgroup of $\text{O}(2)$.

Identify $\mathbb{R}^2$ with $\mathbb{C}$, and the regular n -gon has vertices $1, \zeta, \dots, \zeta^{n-1}$ with $\zeta = e^{\frac{2\pi i}{n}}$.

- $\sigma := \text{rotation } R\left(\frac{2\pi}{n}\right)$ on $\mathbb{R}^2 = \text{multiplication by } \zeta \text{ on } \mathbb{C} \implies \sigma \in D_{2n}, \mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z} \simeq \langle \sigma \rangle \leq D_{2n}$.
- $\tau := \text{reflection w.r.t. the X-axis on } \mathbb{R}^2 = \text{conjugation on } \mathbb{C} \implies \tau \in D_{2n}, \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z} \simeq \langle \tau \rangle \leq D_{2n}$.
- $\tau\sigma^a\tau^{-1} = \tau\sigma^a\tau = \sigma^{-a}$. Can check over $\mathbb{C}$.

Claim: $D_{2n} = \langle \sigma \rangle \rtimes \langle \tau \rangle \simeq \mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z} \rtimes_{\varphi} \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$ where $\varphi(1 + 2\mathbb{Z})$ maps $a + n\mathbb{Z}$ to $-a + n\mathbb{Z}$.

Proof

- $D_{2n} \cap \text{SO}(2) = \langle \sigma \rangle$, $\because$ any rotation $\in D_{2n}$ must send 1 to $\zeta^a, a \in \mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z} \implies$ it is σ^a .
- $\text{SO}(2) \triangleleft \text{O}(2) \implies \langle \sigma \rangle \triangleleft D_{2n}$.
- $\tau \notin \text{SO}(2)$, hence $\langle \sigma \rangle \cap \langle \tau \rangle = \{\text{id}\}$.
- $\tau\sigma^a\tau^{-1} = \sigma^{-a} \implies$ the description of φ .
- Remains to show $D_{2n} = \langle \sigma \rangle \langle \tau \rangle$.

Let $g \in D_{2n}, g(1) = \zeta^k \implies (\sigma^{-k}g)(1) = 1 \in \mathbb{C}$.

In $\mathbb{C}$ we have $\langle 1 \rangle^{\perp} = \langle i \rangle \implies \sigma^{-k}g$ has matrix $\begin{pmatrix} 1 & \\ & \pm 1 \end{pmatrix}$.

- “+” $\implies \sigma^{-k}g = \text{id}$ in $D_{2n}, g = \sigma^k$.

- “-” $\implies \sigma^{-k}g = \tau$ in $D_{2n}, g = \sigma^k\tau$. □

Remark For any $n \geq 1$, we can define $D_{2n} = \mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z} \rtimes_{\varphi} \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$ where $\varphi(1 + 2\mathbb{Z})$ maps $a + n\mathbb{Z}$ to $-a + n\mathbb{Z}$. In this sense $D_2 = \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}, D_4 = \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z} \times \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$.